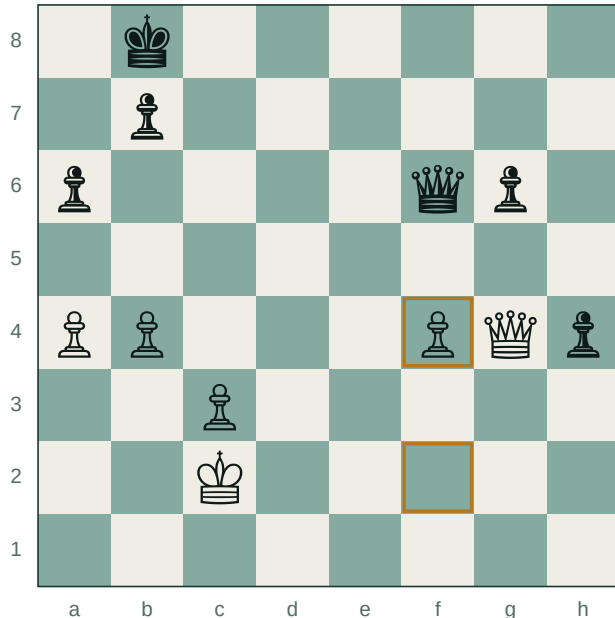


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 31

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 31.f4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Qf5+ 32. Qxf5 gxf5

31...Qf5+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From f5 it attacks king on c2 and queen on g4. Recorded reply: **32.Qxf5**.

32...gxf5 The pawn captures the queen on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on c2. Geometrically undefended: queen on g4. Check for tactical protection.